

and corners) and also tested the display for color accuracy. The Asus Zenbook 14 OLED passed our tests with flying colors. With 100% sRGB coverage and 98% DCI-P3 coverage in our test results, the Zenbook 14 OLED lives surely lives up to its claims. We logged average brightness levels of 366 nits, which is excellent again given the screen size. What impressed us most was the average delta value in our color accuracy tests, the values were between 1 and 3, which is very good when it comes to consumer-grade laptop displays. In a nutshell, you get bright, vivid, accurate colors that make using the Asus Zenbook 14 OLED an absolute joy to use.

What we wish was better though, is the ultra-glossy nature of the display, the reflections can get very annoying, and a special layer on top to curb down the reflections would make the display nearly perfect. The glossy display particularly becomes a pain point during dark scenes in movies, we struggled to resolve the issue, especially in normal office or even home environments where there is going to be a light source to cause reflections.

## 12-HOUR BATTERY LIFE

Asus claims 15 hours of battery life on the ZenBook 14 OLED, which is not a ridiculous claim, unlike many other laptop manufacturers that quote numbers closer to 20 hours of battery life with a string of conditions attached. In our battery life tests, which typically put the laptop through a mixed usage scenario that is closer to real-world usage, we managed to get 11 hours and 35 minutes of battery life on a full charge. This is particularly laudable given that it comes without any compromise on performance. Usually, excellent battery life on thin and light laptops comes at the cost of performance, as they end up coming with low-power processors that prioritize battery life over performance.

We are happy to report that Asus Zenbook 14 OLED trumps on both counts, performance, and battery life. A combination that is hard to get and the credit largely goes to the Intel Core Ultra 155H processor that manages to ace the performance per watt metric here. Asus

also deserves a pat on the back for juicing the Zenbook 14 OLED with a beefy 75WHr battery and also offering fast charging to sweeten the deal.

## PREMIUM DESIGN

The all-metal chassis feels assuring and well-finished in most places, we don't have any specific complaints about the way the laptop looks and feels to the touch. It does have a certain level of premium feel and heft that makes it worth the asking price. However, in many ways the design seems to be a safe bet, there's nothing about the design that makes you go wow! And that can be a factor, especially in the case of premium thin and light laptops where looks and the "premium-ness" is most certainly a purchase driver. Simply put, the Asus Zenbook 14 OLED is not the most good-looking thin and light laptop out there. The metal surfaces also do catch smudges easily, but that's the case with all metal-based laptops, so keeping it shinning and smudge-free will call for frequent wipes.

The keyboard on the Zenbook 14 does help in giving an assuring typing experience, the keys are raised and the feedback is adequate. We found the size of the keys to be just about adequate, they could have been larger, Asus could have utilized the space on either side of the keyboard to make the overall keyboard area wider, to make space for larger keys. We might be nitpicking here but for a good reason. The brilliant performance across the board makes us want more from the Asus Zenbook 14 OLED on the design front where it's all good but nothing great or exceptional to write home about. The 1080p webcam on the Asus Zenbook 14 OLED is quite good and the fact that Asus gave a physical shutter earns the Zenbook 14 some extra points in our scoring sheet. On the flip side, the Zenbook 14 misses out on a fingerprint sensor, which we feel is a big miss. Not everyone including us is comfortable with face scanning (Windows Hello) based login as the only option for password-less access. We aren't sure why Asus skimped on the basis for such a premium device. The down-firing speakers on the Asus Zenbook 14 OLED gave

surprisingly high volume levels without any audible distortion, and the vocals were very clear and well-pronounced, however, the overall sound stage is very directional (as expected). The speakers are more tuned for online meetings and that's the right call in our books. They are loud and clear when it comes to vocals but aren't full or won't win any medals for immersive sound.

As far as connectivity and ports are concerned, the Asus Zenbook 14 OLED has you well covered. The full-size HDMI port is appreciated, you also get an ethernet adapter in the box along with a laptop sleeve as included accessories.

## VERDICT

The latest in the Asus Zenbook lineup, the all-new Asus Zenbook 14 OLED comes with a host of improvements across the board. No compromise on performance or battery life, and the much-improved Intel ARC IGP graphics performance is the cherry on top. All of this makes the Asus Zenbook 14 OLED a power-packed machine that is ready for the on-device generative AI workloads and applications which is a rapidly evolving space. The 3K OLED display with a 120Hz dynamic refresh rate is one of the highlights that lends an edge to the Asus Zenbook 14 OLED. The Asus Zenbook 14 OLED is also priced very aggressively, making it an attractive buy for anyone looking for a no-compromise thin and light laptop that is ready for a multi-dimensional use case.

—Soham Raninga

## SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Intel Core Ultra 7 155H with 16 cores (including dedicated dual NPU cores for AI workloads) and multi-threaded support for up to 22 threads | Graphics: Intel Arc with 8 cores with maximum dynamic GPU clock speed of up to 2.25 GHz | RAM and Storage: 32GB LPDDR5X in dual-channel, 1TB M.2 NVMe PCIe 4.0 SSD | Display: 14-inch 3K (2880 x 1800 pixels) OLED Touch screen panel with a 16:10 aspect ratio, 0.2ms response time, 120Hz dynamic refresh rate, with 500nits HDR peak brightness | Battery: 75WHrs, 4-cell Li-ion with fast charging support via TYPE-C, 65W AC Adapter | Materials and Weight: All-metal chassis, 1.28 kilograms

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